

HUM 103: ETHICS AND CULTURE FALL 2024

MARKS DISTRIBUTION AND ASSESSMENTS

Effort Based 40%

15% - Participation, Class Activities and Group Work (*free write, focused free write, brainstorming, group-reading, loop writing, collaborative reading, annotation, etc.*)

15% - Reflections (expanding on the In-class Writing) (*4 reflections/process writing based on in-class writing/the texts they are reading, 5 marks each, submitted via Turnitin*)

5%- Social Learning Lab (*Activity and Write-up*)

5% - Presentation or class facilitation

Merit Based 60%

30%- Midterm (*argumentative essay*)

30%- Final Project (*multimedia/group project with an individual writing component, suggested no.: 3-4 members per group, suggestion: a small evaluation form for everyone to fill out on each other's involvement*)

COURSE ASSESSMENT MODULES & METHODS

1. Mandatory Class Attendance

Please note that attendance for this course is mandatory in order to participate in the classroom activities and discussions. A part of your grade will be allocated for regular attendance in all sessions.

2. Participation, Classroom Discussions and Activities

In line with the objectives of the School of General Education, this course will heavily focus on a range of learning exercises during our classroom session. Therefore, in addition to clarifying lecture and reading materials, the in-class sessions will be devoted to a variety of reading, writing, small-group discussion, and collaborative learning exercises. This assessment criteria will comprise fifteen percent (15%) of your cumulative grade.

3. In-class Write-up / Reflection/ Journal

Each class, students will be given a writing assignment during class time. Theories and content discussed in class discussions and practical implication of the knowledge will be tested. Structured questions will be given for the students to share their thoughts and ideas, which will be discussed by the course instructor for further development to submit in the form of a consolidated short reflection of 300-400 words on Turnitin. The student in class Write up/Reflection will comprise fifteen percent (15%) of your cumulative grades.

4. Presentations or Class Facilitation

For Presentations: students will provide a brief power-point presentation on the scope of the content. For Class facilitation: students will pick excerpts from the text and prepare a short 6-8 minute discussion on the materials and two discussion questions as the opening of the class facilitation followed by discussion with their peer's views. In both cases, students will select the topic of presentation during the first/second week of the course. Further instructions on the content and methodology of the presentations and class facilitation will be discussed in class. The student presentations or class facilitation will comprise five percent (5%) of your cumulative grade.

5. SLL Participation & Reflection Write-up

Every student takes part in experiential learning activities of the Social Learning Lab (SLL). The Social Learning Lab has two phases; the first is the practical day when students undertake different campus jobs and put themselves in the shoes of staff members for a day, and experience life from their point of view;

The second phase is a reflection write-up. Students will write and submit a reflection paper based on the practical phase as a part of the Applied Ethics topics at the end of the semester. The Reflection paper will help students to develop sensitivity and skills consistent with an ethical approach to others, which is one of the core objectives of the program. The reflection paper will make up five percent (5%) of the course grade. Further instructions on the reflection paper writing will be discussed in class. This exercise will be evaluated based on your participation during the practical phase, effort and completion of the writing.

6. Take-Home Assignment

Students will be required to complete one take-home examination that tests your knowledge and comprehension of the course materials (lectures and readings). Word limit will be 1000-1200 words. This assessment will be evaluated on the basis of their merit. Further instructions about the essay exams will be provided in class. One take-home examination will comprise thirty percent (30%) of your cumulative grade.

7. Multimedia-based Group Project:

Analyzing different themes using multimedia sources and/or methods. It is a Group Project consisting of 3 to 4 students in each group. The project will be supervised by the faculty. Further instructions about the module will be provided in class. This project will comprise thirty percent (30%) of your cumulative grade.

Class	Topic	Learning materials
Theme 1: Introduction to Ethics and Culture		
1	Introduction - Ice-breaking session - Overview of course contents, assessment modalities and important deadlines - Brief introduction to ethics, culture and applied ethics	A short presentation with 6-10 images will be used to discuss how ethics ties in with topical issues and how cultural practices impact these considerations. <u>Mandatory Readings</u> 1. Manuel Velazquez, <i>Philosophy A Text with Readings</i> (2010), 432- 437 2. L. Pojman & J. Fischer, <i>Discovering Right and Wrong</i> (2016), 1-11. OR Article by Velasquez et al. https://www.scu.edu/ethics/ethics-resources/ethical-decision-making/thinking-ethically/ <u>Suggested Multimedia</u> 1) Ethics (On Principles, Values, Actions, Impact) 2) BUx lectures: Part 1: Introduction to Ethics and Morality Part 2: Metaethical Question and Moral Realism Part 3: Moral Relativism Part 4: Relativism in Morality Part 5: Normative Ethics
2	Ethics, applied ethics and Culture / Human Condition - keynotes on core concepts - ethics, ethical reasoning -utilitarianism -deontology - foregrounding care ethics, feminist ethics, trauma and remembering (to set the background for Antigone)	<u>Mandatory reading/listening:</u> 1) Reading: Spencer Oatey - Culture (page 4-5) 2) Podcast on Beyond Cockroach Ethics - Part 1 (Utilitarianism vs Deontology) Inclass (video): 1) Introduction to Applied Ethics OR 2) AI, Racism in Algorithm <u>Supplementary Readings</u> 1) Velazquez, <i>Philosophy: A Text with Readings</i>, 455-463; 2) Manuel Velazquez, <i>Philosophy A Text with Readings</i> (2010), 432- 437 3) Article by Velasquez et al. https://www.scu.edu/ethics/ethics-resources/ethical-decision-making/thinking-ethically/ 4) Spencer-Oatey, H. (2012) What is culture? A compilation of quotations. GlobalPAD Core Concepts.

Class	Topic	Learning materials
Theme 2: Human Condition and Ethics		
3	Antigone -Selected scenes and segments - Central themes (power, oppression, loyalty to family and the state, death and dying- rituals, emotions and beliefs), lived experiences as vehicles for ethical reasoning integrity to oneself and others (Each faculty should pick which theme they would like to individually discuss each class)	<u>Mandatory Reading:</u> Sophocles, <i>Antigone</i>. Suggested multimedia: 1) In Our Time (episode on Antigone) (podcast)

Class	Topic	Learning materials
4	Antigone -Selected scenes and segments - Central themes (power, oppression, loyalty to family and the state, death and dying- rituals, emotions and beliefs), lived experiences as vehicles for ethical reasoning integrity to oneself and others (Each faculty should pick which theme they would like to individually discuss each class)	<u>Supplementary Readings</u> Sophocles, <i>Antigone</i>. Excerpts from Arendt, <i>The Human Condition</i> Power (definitions) https://creaworld.org/wp-content/uploads/2020/07/All-About-Power.pdf (Exercise embedded for In Class Activity) Pg 17, lived experiences (examples for class)

Class	Topic	Learning materials
5	Antigone -Selected scenes and segments - Forms of conflict, sites of discrimination, dimensions of social issues - Impact on human condition - lived experiences as vehicles for ethical reasoning integrity to oneself and others (Each faculty should pick which theme they would like to individually discuss each class)	<u>Mandatory Reading:</u> Sophocles, <i>Antigone</i>.

Class	Topic	Learning materials
6	Antigone -Selected scenes and segments - Forms of conflict, sites of discrimination, dimensions of social issues - Impact on human condition - lived experiences as vehicles for ethical reasoning integrity to oneself and others (Each faculty should pick which theme they would like to individually discuss each class)	<u>Mandatory Reading:</u> Sophocles, <i>Antigone</i>.
Theme 3: Human Condition and Ethics- Ethical Theories		
Suggestion: Faculty may incorporate the themes from Antigone as they discuss these theories.		
7	The Ancients: Part 1 Socrates, Plato and Aristotle	<u>Mandatory readings:</u> Plato, “Laches” in The Dialogues of Plato, vol. 1, 98-120. (AND/OR) Aristotle, Nicomachean Ethics, selected pages. <u>Suggested Multimedia:</u> 1) BUx lectures: 1.1) Dialogues of Definition Part I- Socrates: Dialogues of Definition Part II- Socratic Method and Definition Part III- The Laches by Plato Part IV- Plato's Republic: Parts of the Soul and Four Cardinal Virtues 1.2) Virtue Ethics Part I- Concept of Virtue Part II- The Doctrine of Mean Part III- An Introduction to Virtue Ethics 2)

Class	Topic	Learning materials
8	The Ancients: Part 2 Confucius, Mencius, Xunzi	<u>Mandatory Reading:</u> Confucius, The Analects of Confucius, Bk II & IV. <u>Suggested Multimedia:</u> 1) BUx lecture: 1.1) The Teaching of Confucius Part I- Confucius: A Moral and Political Philosopher Part II- Confucianism: An Introduction Part III- Central Concepts of Confucianism Part IV- Confucian Ethics: Without an End 1.2) Confucians and Critics Part I- Confucians and Critics Part II- Mencius on Human Nature Part III- Xunzi on Human Nature Part IV- Prominent Critics: Mozi and Laozi
9	Utilitarianism - basics of teleological ethics - act and rule utilitarianism - thought experiment: the trolley problem - limitations: radical subjectivity and recognizing the other	<u>Mandatory Reading:</u> 1) J. Bentham, Principles of Morals and Legislation, Ch. 1,2, 4 (Select excerpts) 2) J.S. Mill <i>Utilitarianism</i>. Pg1-10 (Select excerpts) <u>In class material:</u> Video: The Trolley Problem <u>Suggested Multimedia:</u> 1) Podcast on Beyond Cockroach Ethics - Part 1 (Utilitarianism vs Deontology) 2) BUx Lectures: Part I- Utilitarianism and other ethical theories Part II- Bentham and his Hedonic Calculus Part III- Mill: Distinction between Pleasures Part IV- Act and Rule Utilitarianism <u>Supplementary Readings</u> Peter Singer, "Famine, Affluence and Morality"
10	Deontology - moral duty and maxims - hypothetical and categorical imperatives - thought experiment: Kant's axe - limitations	<u>In Class Materials</u> Video: Kant's Axe Case studies: July 2024, current events 2024 <u>Preparatory Readings</u> 1) Velazquez, Philosophy: A Text with Readings, 455-463 2) <u>Suggested multimedia:</u> 1.1) Deontological Ethics I: The Good Will:

Class	Topic	Learning materials
		Part I- Kant's Ethical Approach and Criticism of Virtue Part II- Deontology and Rationality Part III- Theorizing Duty 1.2) Deontological Ethics II: The Categorical Imperative Part I- Hypothetical & Categorical Imperatives Part II- The Categorical Imperative Part III- Kant's Examples Part IV- Formulations of Categorical Imperative & Limitations
11	Feminist Ethics - feminism - feminist critique of traditional ethical theories - feminist lens on social justice (understanding oppression, where it stems from and how it perpetuates)	<u>Preparatory Readings</u> Audre Lorde, “The Transformation of Silence into Language and Action,” 40-44 OR Rokeya Shakhawat Hossain, “Sultana’s Dream” OR M. Wollstonecraft, The Vindication of the Rights of Women, 88-113 & 179-188
12	Care Ethics - care and justice - the burden of care - reframing care as a site for analyzing oppression (care for whom and at the cost of whom)	Audre Lorde on Self care Case studies(multimedia) of care work: - Emergencies - “Normal” times - Unpaid/ Erased https://www.instagram.com/reel/DATDrjjI3G0/?igsh=Nzk1bjJ5Y3VjcnV5 on Lorde and self care Supplementary Reading Grimshaw, J. (1991). The idea of a female ethic. In P. Singer (Ed.), A companion to ethics (pp. 491–499). Blackwell. Rachels, J., & Rachels, S. (2018). Feminism and the ethics of care. In The elements of moral philosophy (9th ed., pp. 156–168). McGraw-Hill. (Section on Care ethics and its criticism) K. Mackay, Feminism and Feminist Ethics, 64-74
Theme 4: Applied Ethics		
Suggestion: Faculty can incorporate the themes from Antigone as they discuss these theories with students.		

Class	Topic	Learning materials
13	Difference, discrimination and intolerance - intersection (race, class, religion, gender, ethnicity) - exploitation and injustice - colonialism and colonial exploitation	<u>Mandatory Reading</u> Chapter 4 The Spectacle of the Other (from Representation)- Stuart Hall (pg 228 preferred meaning; pg 234-235 why does difference matter; pg 243 binary oppositions; pg 249 stereotypes) <u>Supplementary Reading</u> UchachaA Chak “The politics of the 'clash' between Bangalees and Paharis” https://thegreatwave.thedailystar/shortlink Muktasree Chakma Sathi, “Will the interim government be truly anti-discriminatory?” https://www.thedailystar.net/opinion/views/news/will-the-interim-government-be-truly-anti-discriminatory-3672606 SPaRC’s Womanifesto https://apwld.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/09/Bangladesh_SPaRC.pdf J. K. Kauanui, “A Structure, Not an Event”: Settler Colonialism and Enduring Indigeneity https://www.jstor.org/stable/48671433 (Drive) <u>Multimedia:</u> 1. _ (Tufan Chakma’s art) https://www.facebook.com/tufansArtbin/ 2. <u>In and Out of South Asia: Race, Capitalism and Mobility</u> (playlist of videos on panels which faculty can choose from) 3. <u>Geographies of Racial Capitalism with Ruth Wilson Gilmore</u> (video) 4. <u>Racial Capitalism: Actually Existing Capitalism</u> (video)
14	Justice and Injustice Framing the topic as a discussion on what comprises Justice and what comprises Injustice? (Can an impartial theory of Justice be put forth?) Principles : Theory of Justice - Introduce concepts of Maximin rule	Excerpts from A Theory of Justice, Rawls <u>Supplementary Readings</u> Excerpts from G.A Cohen, C. Mills- Racial Contract M. Nussbaum- For love of country (with A. Sen, response) Education for profit, education for freedom (critiques of Rawls, need to be compiled - will be updated in Drive).

Class	Topic	Learning materials
	- Circumstance of justice, Veil of ignorance (as a way of objectively talking about justice, outside of personal interest) - Original position (and later position which includes a communitarian perspective), to lead to a discussion on principles, why lawyers, judges etc formulate impersonal/ seemingly objective laws. Critique: - decolonial/anticolonial critics of Justice (and the impartial/ objective)	
15	Class, inequality and discrimination - Basic concepts of Marxist theory - Class system - Capitalism & social change - Bourgeois & proletarian classes - Class struggle & revolution - Colonialism, capitalism, and modernity - Destructive aspects of colonialism	Mandatory Reading: 1) K. Marx Communist Marx 2) Louis Althusser, "Ideology and Ideological State Apparatuses," page 9-13 (definitions of RSA, ISA), 19-20 (notion of ideology)
16	Gender-based discrimination and gender-based violence - gender, gender-based power and gender inequalities - toxic masculinity and burdens of masculinity and femininity - feminist movements in Bangladesh and their contributions	<u>Supplementary Readings</u> 1) Men, Masculinities and Changing powers (2 pages) 2) Women's movement in Bangladesh- Firdaus Azim 3) Judith Butler- Undoing Gender, Chapter One- Acting in Concert Suggested supporting materials: 1) Links on Feminist interventions and State-Building: https://bdfeministarchives.org/ 2) Feminists: What were they thinking? (documentary on Netflix)

Class	Topic	Learning materials
Theme 4: Issues in Focus and Sites of Conflict- Extended		
Instruction: Faculty will select and teach 3 topics from below to teach in class		
17	Religions and faith based inclusivity (Optional) - Pluralism, Plurality, Pluriverse - interreligious and interfaith dialogue - peace and community building through nurturing religious harmony in a plural society - care ethics and spiritual traditions	<u>Readings:</u> 1. “What is Ethics?”- Manuel Velasquez (pg 3) 2. “Reimagining Justice as Preservative Care for Sustained Peace: Learning from Ethics of Care and Indigenous Philosophies” - Robert Michael Ruehl (Recapitulation, pgs 372-374) Multimedia for Preparation (provided to students to view in their own time): 2. Interfaith Cooperation: An Invitation for All Beliefs (video) 3. Islam, Judaism and Christianity- A conversation (video) Multimedia (Inclass) What is interreligious dialogue? How faith based organizations achieve UN sustainable goals 2030 Suggested cases: 1. Easter and Iftar celebrants in Belgium feast together (video) 2. Sacred Stewardship: The Moral Imperative of Religious Leaders in Climate Advocacy (op-ed) 3. The House of One (website) <u>Supplementary Reading</u> Care Ethics, Religion and Spiritual Traditions (faculty can select chapters to assign as supplementary reading)
18	Environment and Climate Change (Optional) - Environmental Ethics - Climate Justice - Anthropocene - Multispecies - Ecology - Natural/Unnatural dichotomy	<u>Readings</u> 1. ““The goat that died for family”. Animal sacrifice and interspecies kinship in India’s Central Himalaya”- Radhika Govindarajan (pgs 507-508) 2. When Species Meet- Donna Haraway (Ch 1 and 10) Cases: 1. Floods in Bangladesh August 2024 2. “When the levees break” by Spike Lee Supplementary materials:

Class	Topic	Learning materials
		Conversations in Anthropology (interview with Govindarajan, podcast episode no. 38)
19	Science and Technology in the era of AI (Optional) - Disinformation, misinformation - Surveillance - Subjectivity and social media - Cyborgs/ AI/ Humans - Virality and cultures	Algorithmic Justice - Video https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UG_X_7g63rY Black Mirror, Leila (Netflix) Loukissas, Y. A. (2019). "Introduction: From Data Sets to Data Settings." <i>All data are local: Thinking critically in a data-driven society</i>. MIT press. OR Excerpts: Donna Haraway, <i>The Cyborg Manifesto</i> (Excerpts) OR Deepfake and communication technologies https://deeperinsights.com/ai-blog/deepfake-reality-promise-vs-peril <u>Multimedia</u> "Death by Metadata" https://www.democracynow.org/2014/2/10/death_by_metadata_a_jeremy_scahill_glenn
20	Solidarity & Resistance (Optional) - Political philosophy and social actions - Transnational, Anticolonial - Volunteering/Voluntourism - Need for allies - Theories in/of social movements - Repertoires of contention - Cultural change as knowledge production	Bastards of Utopia(2010) by M. Razsa, P. Velez https://www.enmassefilms.org/remix/the-film/, https://vimeo.com/188424121 Documentary on Rampal Power Plant movement Case studies: Open Letters post-July Uprising <u>Readings</u> G. Orwell, <i>Animal Farm</i> (Excerpts) OR. F. Fanon, <i>The Wretched of the Earth</i> (Excerpts) OR A Bayat <i>Life as Politics: How Ordinary People changed the Middle East</i> (Excerpts)

Class	Topic	Learning materials
21	Feedback moment/final project presentation/writing day	